Presentation systems, too, have played a major role in the way we play our games today. Systems such as DirectX have taken gaming to a higher level in terms of realistic graphics and sound quality. Thin games—or games with a large amount of the textures and images stored on a common server—will be one of the future paths gaming might take. Multiplayer games on the Internet will soon be the norm.

Talking of thin games and Internet gaming brings us to the new path a few game developers are taking—that of reinventing the engine. Games such as KKrieger, which takes up just 96 KB, could be indicative of the future of gaming. This FPS occupies almost no space on your hard disk, but the gameplay is as good as in a 'regular' FPS, and the graphics quality is stunning.

How does such as small file generate such high-end graphics and textures? The answer lies in real-time graphics. The game's engine generates the graphics on the fly. This means that as you play, the game engine understands your moves and creates the appropriate texture and images. Apart from the obvious advantage of saving you disk space, this also ensures the graphics you see are more realistic and in sync with your actions. Games such as these, however, will require very high-end machines.

Whichever way the industry moves, you can be sure it would be only to enhance your gaming experience and make you gasp for more. Time to check the *Skoar*!